

of a mountain, and after boiling them in a small kettle, to thrust them through a chink in the mountain side. The implacable Louhi next sends the bear to devastate the flocks of Kalewala; but Wäinämöinen, favoured by the sylvan deity Tapio, captures the animal while it is sleeping in a wood, and taking it home, skins and eats it with great solemnity. It is worthy of observation that the bear, while treated as an enemy, is accosted with all the terms of endearment that might be addressed to a favourite child, were it not for the expressions of veneration that are mingled with the blandishments, as this marks the very equivocal position which is held by the animal in the Finnish mythology.

Indulging in the exercise of his musical talent, Wäinämöinen, on one occasion, plays so beautifully on his harp, that the sun and moon come down and settle on two lofty trees; thus enabling Louhi to fulfil her most singular threat, for she carries off both the luminaries to Pohjola, and encloses them in a rock. Not only is Kalewala thus plunged into utter darkness, but the supreme god, Ukko, is himself embarrassed by the unwonted gloom. To remedy the deficiency, he kindles a fire, a spark of which he puts into a purse embroidered with gold, which he shuts up in a silver box. This is given to a maiden, who is enjoined to shake it until a sufficient flame is produced for the creation of a new sun and moon. The clumsy girl heedlessly allows the spark to escape, and it descends to earth with a tremendous crash, attracting the attention of Wäinämöinen, who sets off with Ilmarinen to ascertain whence the new light issues. Coming to the bank of a river, they proceed in a boat which Ilmarinen furnishes on the spot, and are met by Ilmatar, the "daughter of air," who informs them that the fallen spark, after doing a great deal of mischief, at last fell into the water, where it was swallowed by a fish of the salmon kind. The salmon was tortured by pain till it was swallowed in its turn by a salmon-trout, to whom all the pain was transferred; a pike, who swallowed the salmon-trout, is the last on the list of sufferers.

The capture of the pike is now resolved upon, and Wäinämöinen, after vainly using a net woven of bast, learns from the conversation of the fishes with each other that nothing but flax will answer the purpose. This is not easily to be obtained. The roots of two trees are pulled up, and the required seed, found in the vicinity of a terrible reptile, called "Tuoni's worm," is sown among the ashes of a boat that has been destroyed by fire. It thrives well; and the net is at last made by Wäinämöinen's people. After many fruitless attempts the fish is taken, with the assistance of a little man, who rises out of the waves, in answer to a prayer addressed to the marine deities. When the prey is carried on shore, Wäinämöinen hesitates about touching it with an unarmed hand; but the "son of the sun," who overhears his misgivings, states his readiness to do all that is required, if he is furnished with a knife. No sooner has he spoken the words than a knife falls from heaven, which the "son of the sun" dextrously uses, extricating the salmon-trout from the body of the pike, and the salmon from the body of the salmon-trout. In a ball of thread,